

①

* Geo - Political Compulsions of Russia :-

Winston Churchill once remarked, Russia is a riddle shrouded in mystery, yet there is a key that key is Russia's National Interest.

What is the Core National Interest of any country?
Security — of land and its people.

What is Russia's Vulnerability?

Russia is Vast, & Russia does not have Vulnerability as of now in North as well as in the East. Hence, Russian Core is protected from the threats coming from North and East.

Historically, Russia has been Vulnerable to the invasion from ~~Central~~ Central Asia.

a) Central Asia

Hence, it is Russia's compulsion to expand Central Asia. Even when Russians do not want they have to have their dominance in Central Asia.

↓
This is a Cause of Concern for U.S. b/c Central Asia is Heart of Asia.

Historically, Russia has maintain its dominance in the Region. Historically, it has always been difficult for U.S.A. to maintain its presence.

Hence, U.S. strategies to access Central Asia has been either through —

a) Turkey

b) Pakistan (Afghan — Pakistan Region)

Similarly, Russia requires a line of defence in the west to protect its core. Presently, Russia calls countries in immediate neighbourhood as "Near Abroad".

When it was USSR, Russia had 2 layers of defence —

1st layer — Countries in immediate neighbourhood. They were included in USSR. USSR was formed in 1922.

Gradually, it became a confederation of 15 States/Republics.

In the 2nd layer of defence came East European countries like — Poland, Hungary, Bulgaria.

They were the members of "WARSAW PACT".

Historically, Russia has maintain the influence in the Region.

i) Under Tsarist Empire

ii) Under USSR — where ideology was used as a tool.

Russians are compared with bear b/c their presence has not been welcomed in the neighbourhood for many reasons.

i) Under Tsars —

— To prevent invading Army Russian used to apply Scorched Earth Policy — burning the Agriculture so that armies of Enemy do not get Reinforcement. Hence, there has been anger Against Russia among the neighbours.

NOTE!— Presently, among EU Countries, the Eastern Countries w/c were earlier the members of "WARSAW PACT" are strongly against Russians.

ii) Under USSR —

— During the time of USSR, Russia took the advantage of the 'W.W.IInd', Russian forces were present in East European Countries. Russia took the opportunity to install puppet Regimes in the Communism.

Q) What was the nature of 'this' Regime?

They are Dictatorship. Hence, there was a Resentment among the people in these states against Russia.

NOTE!— When Moscow became weak, Unable to support the Puppet Regime, Communism in Eastern Europe started Collapsing. like— House of Cards.

Q) Why Communism Collapse so easily?

- B/c it was not based on the support of the People.

Thus, the compulsion of Russia is to expand for survival. Expansion of Russia is a nightmare for U.S.A.

Q) What other problems Russia faces b/c of the Geo-political Compulsion to expand?

④

i) When Russia Expands Non-Russian becomes the part of Political System. Since, they are not ethnically Russians, there is a lack of trust. Hence, Russian state will have to maintain huge State structure. (Especially Surveillance System).

Russia has one of the best Secret services. Bigger is the state structure, more will be the Corruption, more drain of Resources.

Russia is already Economically weak. There is a point beyond which it can't manage such a huge State Apparatus. Hence, Russia has to Contract.

Another Vulnerability of Russia is its landlock status.

Till Arctic Region does not become commercially Navigable, the only Exit Russia have to the outside world is through Black Sea. From Black Sea to Mediterranean, here also Russia is blocked. by :-

i) Turkey — though not European State yet, NATO ally.

ii) Israel — Israel is American Outpost in the Region.

Q) What is U.S.A's policy towards Russia?

- Hit where it hurts the most.

The biggest vulnerability of Russia is its Economic.

Though Russia have huge Natural Resources comparable to U.S yet U.S policy has been not to allow Russia to exploit its Natural Resources.

For one or the other Reason U.S. will keep Russia consistently under Economic Sanction.

Thus, U.S. policy towards Russia has been "Beggar thy Enemy Policy".

How? U.S. implement the policy? -

i) Sanction :-

ii) Engaging Russia in Costly Arm Race.

iii) Involving Russia in the Constant war with the neighbours.

This further weakens Russian ability to maintain its influence in near Abroad.

So what is Russia's destiny?

Russia's destiny is determined by its Geography.

It's destiny is to expand & collapse. Hence, Russia is known as "Weak, Great Power".

Q) Whether Cold War was a Geo-political battle?
Yes, it was. That's why rivalry is still continuing.
This shows that they are eternal rivals. At least till U.S.A does not leave its ambition to be a Hegemon.

Can U.S.A leave?

No, b/c Hegemony is a ultimate Guarantee for Security & Prosperity.

* Causes of Cold War :-

Mention the prominent Event which led to the Emergence of Cold war.

Causes :-

- It's a matter of debate :-

- i) Some consider ideological Reason.
- ii) Some consider Geo-Political Reason.

However, since the end of Cold War a new school of thought has emerged in context of Analysis of Cold war known as - "Social Constructivism".

A/c to them, Cold War was not b/c of Contradictory ideology or Geo-Political Compulsion, it was the result of Culture, a specific way of thinking about something.

(7)

* Events led to Cold war :-

• 1917 - Communist Revolution in Russia :-

- Since, Communism has head of ending Capitalism. It created suspicion in the mind of Capitalist World.

Role of Lenin :-

- Lenin was expansionist (Geo-political Compulsion).
A/c to Lenin, Communism in Russia is not safe so long it is surrounded by Capitalist State.
Hence, Lenin established Communist International.
This has further alarmed the Western Countries.

Role of Stalin :-

Stalin didn't have expansionist policy. He only wanted to secure his power hence he gave the idea — Socialism in One Country.

Americans didn't trust Stalin. Hence, Stalin also started expansionist Plan. Stalin formed another Platform for expansion of Communism called as

"COMINFORM". This further created the distrust.

Q) What was Western Plan to deal with Russia?
Western Plan was to use Germany against Russia.

What Stalin did?

He tried to secure Russian position.

In 1939, he entered into "Non-Aggression Pact"
with Hitler.

↓
this pact known as
"Molotov Ribbentrop Pact"

(B)

Beside, Stalin signed Neutrality Pact with Japan in 1941. This convinced West that they have plan to create the ~~axis~~ ^{axis} of Authoritarian state to challenge the democracy.

West was successful in provoking Hitler to attack Russia. Hitler went for the biggest military Expedition of W.W. IInd against Russia. — known as "Operation Barbarossa". It was Hitler's

Blitzkrieg

↳ a shift military Action with the element of surprise.

After this, Russia entered into W.W. IInd. Russia and the west became war-time Allies.

During the War itself, Russia realised that Western Attitude towards ~~for~~ Russia has not changed. It was just a tactical Alliance. (War-time Alliance).

Q5) What gave Russians such impressions ? -

i) Unnecessary delay in opening the 2nd front against Germany. Hence, Russia suffered heavy casualties.

ii) Manhattan Project (Nuclear Project) - U.S. kept Britain & Canada informed about its plan to develop the Nuclear weapon. However, kept secret from Russia.

iii) There was disagreement over the future formation of Governance in European States. Russia wanted Communist Regime in the Eastern Europe for its security. On the other hand, West kept on insisting for Democracy.

There was major disagreement over the future of Germany. Since, Russia had suffered heavily, Russia wanted to impose huge Penalties on Germany.

However, western Arguments were that such policies are dangerous. They gave reference to the term imposed on Germany by "Treaty of Versailles".

This gave impression to Russia that even before the Completion of the war, West has started thinking to Re-build Germany as a but-work against Russia.

The surprise use of Nuclear weapon on Japan.

Why Nuclear Weapon was Used ?

- i) To communicate Russia not to be adamant.
- ii) To prevent the possibility of Presence of Russian forces on Strategically located Island.